



P 4 2 · 1 4 P A G E S , P R I N T A B L E + F I L L A B L E

Babyproofing Room-by-Room Checklist

A fourteen-page room-by-room babyproofing checklist for the pass that has to happen before the baby moves. Living room, kitchen, bathroom, bedrooms, stairs and hallways, outdoor and garage, vehicles, and poison and emergency prep. Hazards described in plain language. No brand recommendations. Plus a prioritization page for the parent who cannot do it all this weekend.

Soothemade Notes

A SMALL APOTHECARY OF PRINTABLES · MADE SLOWLY

A note before you start

Your baby is going to move. They are going to do it sooner than you think.

This checklist is for the weekend you decide to do the babyproofing pass. It is not aspirational. It is the actual list. Living room, kitchen, bathroom, bedrooms, stairs, outdoors, vehicles, poison prep.

What this checklist will not do is tell you which brand of outlet cover to buy. There are 40 of those, they all work, and any one of them is fine. The checklist names the hazard. You figure out the solution that fits your house, your budget, and the way you already live.

The "I cannot do all this today" page at the back ranks the fixes if you have one weekend and not three.

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This is a planning tool. For specific safety questions, your pediatric provider, your fire department, or a certified car-seat technician are the right people to call. Poison Control: 1-800-222-1222 in the US.

When to do the babyproofing pass

For most babies, the window is around 8 to 10 months. Some are earlier. Some are later. The signals:

- ☐ The baby is rolling consistently and getting around the floor.
- ☐ The baby is pulling up on furniture.
- ☐ The baby is putting everything in their mouth.
- ☐ You catch them reaching for something they would not have reached for last week.

If any of these is true, the pass is now.

A small principle: babyproofing is not “make the house safe so the baby can be unsupervised.” It is “remove the worst hazards so the moment of inattention is not catastrophic.” Supervision is still the main tool. The proofing is the second tool.

THE DATE I AM DOING THE PASS: _____

WHO IS HELPING: _____

ROOMS I AM TACKLING FIRST: _____

WHAT I HAVE ALREADY BOUGHT (or borrowed):

- ☐ Outlet covers
- ☐ Cabinet locks
- ☐ Drawer locks
- ☐ Furniture anchors / straps
- ☐ Edge bumpers for sharp corners
- ☐ Stair gates (top + bottom)
- ☐ Doorknob covers
- ☐ Toilet locks
- ☐ Window guards (if upper floor)
- ☐ Cord shorteners or cord cleats
- ☐ Other: _____

Living room

ELECTRICAL

- ☐ All outlets covered (or filled with furniture in front of them)
- ☐ Cords gathered + secured behind furniture
- ☐ TV anchored to wall or to a stable stand
- ☐ Floor lamps anchored or moved

FURNITURE

- ☐ Tall furniture (bookshelves, dressers) anchored to wall
- ☐ Sharp corners on coffee tables addressed (bumpers, or move out)
- ☐ Glass coffee tables: consider removing temporarily
- ☐ Rug edges secured (so they do not flip up when pulled)

WINDOW + BLINDS

- ☐ Window blind cords shortened or eliminated (these are a real risk)
- ☐ Window locks engaged on any window above ground floor

CHOKING + SWALLOW HAZARDS

- ☐ Floor swept for small items (coins, batteries, button cells, magnets)
- ☐ Plants removed if they are toxic (check the type, ask Poison Control if unsure)
- ☐ Decor objects under 1.5 inches relocated up high

OTHER

- ☐ Fireplace screen or guard installed if you have a fireplace
- ☐ Heavy or breakable objects relocated to higher shelves
- ☐ Pet bowls + pet toys raised or relocated (or accept they are now baby toys)

THINGS I AM STILL FIGURING OUT:

Kitchen

The kitchen is the most-hazardous room in most homes. Worth doing first.

CABINETS + DRAWERS

- ☐ All lower cabinets locked (or a single one designated as the "baby cabinet" with safe pots and pans they can play with)
- ☐ Drawer with knives + scissors locked
- ☐ Cabinet under the sink locked (cleaning supplies)
- ☐ Trash can either lidded + closed or moved behind a closed door

APPLIANCES

- ☐ Stove knob covers if knobs are reachable
- ☐ Oven door latch engaged (or oven-specific child lock used)
- ☐ Dishwasher door not left open
- ☐ Cords on counter-top appliances (kettle, coffee maker) shortened or run behind the appliance, not draping down

COUNTER + TABLE

- ☐ Hot foods + hot drinks moved to back of counter
- ☐ Tablecloths removed (a baby can pull the tablecloth and pull the contents down on themselves)
- ☐ Magnets on the fridge: any small ones removed (swallowing risk)

CHOKING + SWALLOW

- ☐ Floor swept for crumbs (small foods are a choking risk)
- ☐ Pet food bowls relocated or only put down when supervised
- ☐ High chair installed correctly + harness used

THINGS I AM STILL FIGURING OUT:

Bathroom

A small room with many hazards. Worth being precise.

WATER + DROWNING RISK

- ☐ Toilet lid kept down, or toilet lock installed
- ☐ Bathtub: never leave unsupervised with a baby in it, ever, for any reason, even for a second
- ☐ Bath thermometer if you want to be sure of temperature
- ☐ Water heater set to 120°F (48°C) maximum if you can adjust it (this is a fire department + pediatric recommendation in many places)

CABINETS

- ☐ Under-sink cabinet locked (cleaners + razors)
- ☐ Medicine cabinet locked or out-of-reach
- ☐ Hair tools (curling iron, straightener) stored unplugged + out of reach (they stay hot)

FLOOR + SLIPS

- ☐ Bath mat secured (a slip in the bathroom is a real risk)
- ☐ Items on bathroom counter relocated (especially anything sharp or breakable)

OTHER

- ☐ Diaper pail lid secured
- ☐ Toilet paper + tissue roll out of reach (they unspool and chew it)

THINGS I AM STILL FIGURING OUT:

Bedrooms

Both the baby's and the parent's, when the baby is mobile.

BABY'S ROOM

- ☐ Crib slats at safe spacing (the crib was certified at purchase, but check it for damage)
- ☐ Mattress firm + tight-fitting
- ☐ Nothing in the crib except a sleep sack and a fitted sheet (no pillows, blankets, stuffed animals, bumpers, until well into toddlerhood per current safe-sleep guidance)
- ☐ Crib not next to a window with cords
- ☐ Outlets covered
- ☐ Lamp cord secured behind furniture
- ☐ Furniture anchored
- ☐ Rug secured
- ☐ Floor lamps moved or anchored
- ☐ Diaper-changing supplies that are reachable: nothing dangerous (no powder above the baby, no small caps within reach)
- ☐ Mobile or hanging decor at safe distance from where the baby can grab

PARENT'S BEDROOM

- ☐ Furniture in the room they may visit: anchored
- ☐ Bedside drawer: nothing dangerous (no medications loose, no small objects, no electronics with batteries)
- ☐ Floor swept under the bed
- ☐ Anything stored under the bed that the baby could reach (suitcases, bags, blankets): assess

THINGS I AM STILL FIGURING OUT:

Stairs and hallways

STAIRS

- ☐ Gate at the top of every staircase, installed correctly (the top one should be hardware-mounted, not pressure-mounted)
- ☐ Gate at the bottom of every staircase
- ☐ Stair treads checked, no loose ones
- ☐ Banister rails: spacing less than 4 inches apart (or use a stair shield if too wide)

HALLWAYS

- ☐ Anything stored along the hallway moved or anchored
- ☐ Door stoppers: avoid the kind with a small removable cap (choking risk if it comes off)
- ☐ Doors that lead to off-limits rooms: latches engaged when not in use

LANDING + ENTRY

- ☐ Front door: deadbolt at an adult-reachable height
- ☐ Strollers, scooters, etc. stored so they cannot fall on the baby
- ☐ Welcome mat secured

THINGS I AM STILL FIGURING OUT:

Outdoor, yard, garage

YARD

- ☐ Gates secured
- ☐ Pool / hot tub: fenced separately with a self-closing, self-latching gate at least 4 feet high (this is non-negotiable wherever there is standing water)
- ☐ Plants identified for toxicity (your local extension service or Poison Control can identify)
- ☐ Compost bin / trash bin lids secured
- ☐ Garden tools stored
- ☐ Fertilizer + pesticides locked away

GARAGE

- ☐ Garage door auto-reverse working (test it)
- ☐ Tools out of reach
- ☐ Cleaning supplies + automotive fluids locked
- ☐ Bicycles secured
- ☐ Anything stored on a shelf above kid-height: stable

DECK / PATIO

- ☐ Railing spacing same as stairs (less than 4 inches)
- ☐ Grill not used while baby is on the deck
- ☐ Outdoor furniture stable

THINGS I AM STILL FIGURING OUT:

Vehicles

CAR SEAT (the single most important item in this entire checklist)

- ☐ Car seat appropriate for current weight + height
- ☐ Installed correctly (a free inspection at a fire station or by a certified passenger safety technician is worth doing)
- ☐ Harness adjusted to fit snugly (you should not be able to pinch the strap at the shoulder)
- ☐ Chest clip at armpit height
- ☐ Rear-facing as long as the seat allows (current pediatric guidance is rear-facing for as long as possible, until they meet the seat's weight or height limit)

CAR

- ☐ Anything stored in the back of the car that could become a projectile in a stop: secured
- ☐ Window controls: lock engaged (so kicking doesn't roll the window)
- ☐ Doors: child locks engaged on rear doors

NEVER (this is the page to be unambiguous)

- ☐ Never leave a baby in the car, even for "just a minute"
- ☐ Never leave a baby unattended near a moving vehicle
- ☐ Never put a car seat on a counter or table (they tip)

THINGS I AM STILL FIGURING OUT:

Poison + emergency prep

The checklist that matters most when it matters.

POISON CONTROL

US Poison Control: 1-800-222-1222
(Save this in your phone now, not later)

Canadian Poison Centre numbers vary by province.
Save the one for your region.

UK National Poisons Information Service: Call 111 (NHS)

KEEP HIGH AND LOCKED

- ☐ All medications, prescription and OTC (out of reach, in a locked spot, original containers with labels). Do NOT keep medications in food containers or unmarked bottles.
- ☐ All vitamins + supplements (iron is a notable risk for kids)
- ☐ Cleaning supplies
- ☐ Laundry pods (these look like candy and are a real risk)
- ☐ Dishwasher pods
- ☐ Hand sanitizer (high alcohol content)
- ☐ Mouthwash
- ☐ Essential oils
- ☐ Nail polish + remover
- ☐ Personal care products (deodorant, perfume, sunscreen, etc.)
- ☐ Automotive fluids
- ☐ Pet medications
- ☐ Alcohol (including the wine bottle on the counter)

SMOKE + CARBON MONOXIDE

- ☐ Smoke alarms tested + batteries fresh (test monthly, replace yearly if not hardwired)
- ☐ Carbon monoxide detector installed if you have any fuel-burning appliances or an attached garage
- ☐ Fire extinguisher accessible to adults

WHAT TO TEACH EVERY ADULT IN THE HOUSE

- ☐ How to do infant CPR (a class is the right way to learn)
- ☐ The Poison Control number
- ☐ The pediatrician's office number + after-hours line

- ☐ The nearest pediatric ER

A FIRE PLAN

- ☐ Two exits identified from each room
- ☐ A meeting spot outside
- ☐ Practice once a year as a household

THINGS I AM STILL FIGURING OUT:

“I cannot do all this today”

You will not get every item on this checklist done today. You may not get it done this month. That is fine. Babyproofing happens in waves, as the baby's skills change.

If you have one weekend, do these:

TIER 1 (DO FIRST, the things that matter most)

- ☐ Anchor any tall furniture in rooms the baby spends time in
- ☐ Lock the kitchen cabinets that have cleaners + sharps
- ☐ Lock the under-sink cabinets in bathroom + kitchen
- ☐ Cover the outlets in the main rooms the baby is in
- ☐ Shorten any window-blind cords
- ☐ Install gates at the top + bottom of stairs
- ☐ Verify the car seat is installed correctly
- ☐ Save Poison Control in your phone
- ☐ Move medications + supplements to a locked spot
- ☐ Sweep floors of small items

TIER 2 (NEXT FEW WEEKENDS)

- ☐ Bumper any sharp coffee-table corners
- ☐ Anchor TVs
- ☐ Toilet locks
- ☐ Stove knob covers if applicable
- ☐ Hardware-mount the top-stair gate (not pressure-mount)
- ☐ Test smoke + CO alarms
- ☐ Identify two exits per room
- ☐ Inventory plants

TIER 3 (BEFORE WALKING + AS THEY GROW)

- ☐ Doorknob covers on rooms that are off-limits
- ☐ Cabinet locks throughout
- ☐ Window guards on upper-floor windows
- ☐ Reassess the yard
- ☐ CPR class for any adult who has not done one

WHAT IS DONE TODAY:

WHAT WILL BE DONE NEXT WEEKEND:

A reminder: no house is perfectly proofed. The goal is "the worst hazards are addressed and the baby can be supervised normally without you guarding every drawer." Perfect is not the bar. Reasonable is.

A final note

You walked through your own house with the eyes of someone who has never lived there. That is what babyproofing actually is.

The list is not done. It will keep updating. By 18 months, you will be looking at things you did not even think were reachable. By 3 years, you will be reading labels on every cleaner. By 5, you will be teaching them.

The checklist is the start. The supervision is the rest of it.

You are doing the work. They are about to move.

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Soothemade *Notes*

*Made for the version of you no one tells you about, the
one at four in the morning, the one in the parking lot, the
one who doesn't recognize her own week.*

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